

	DOCUMENT NAME	INTERNAL AUDIT CHECKLIST (AEC)				
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AUDIT CHECKLIST (AEC)

REQUIREMENTS FOR BINDT AUTHORISED EXAMINATION CENTRE

1. General requirement		
1.1	The Controlling AQB is responsible for all aspects of the administration of PCN examinations conducted at any AEC under their direct control and that appears on their AQB scope of Approval. There shall be a documented process defining how the AQB administers and controls the examination process at any given AEC.	
2 Premises/Facilities		
2.1	AQBs and their AECs represent the image and reputation of BINDT. Consequently, AQB/AEC premises and facilities are expected to present a professional image at all times. Housekeeping and presentation shall remain at the highest level. BINDT retains the right to remove approvals if in the opinion of its agents the premises/facilities reflect badly on the professional image and reputation of BINDT.	
2.2	The premises used for examinations shall comply with the latest issue of all relevant national statutory legislation, e.g. in the UK the Health and Safety at Work Act, COSHH Regulations and where applicable, Ionising Radiation Regulations. Where local regulations are non-existent or lax BINDT still expects AQBs/AECs to maintain a high ethos and culture in respect of Health and Safety.	
2.3	With regard to Radiographic facilities, and irrespective of local legislation, the AQB/AEC shall ensure the following safety requirements exist. • Sufficient Radiation warning signage and lights. • Exposure rooms capable of containing the level and type of radiation used. • A physical barrier at the entry to exposure rooms when radiation equipment is activated. • Calibrated Radiation monitoring equipment TLD/Film badges or calibrated personnel radiation beepers for all students	
2.4	The AEC shall provide quiet examination rooms supplied with all necessary services (heat, power, lighting & separation of candidates etc.), and all facilities provided shall comply with all relevant statutory health and safety legislation requirements applicable in the country of operations. There must be a gap of not less than 1.5 metres between candidates, measured between adjacent shoulders during written examinations	
2.5	Where premises are shared between training and examination, there shall be no joint usage of the facilities, i.e. examinations shall not take place whilst the facilities are being used for training or vice versa.	

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3 Impartiality & Confidentiality

3.1	All AEC staff involved in any aspect of the administration or conduct of PCN examinations shall be impartial with respect to candidates and their employers.	
3.2	All AEC staff involved in the PCN Examination process shall sign a commitment to confidentiality and impartiality in regard of the PCN examination process. Form PCN24/PSL56 shall be used for this purpose. By signing PCN24/PSL56 AEC staff give an undertaking comply with the rules defined in the specific PCN document that applies to their particular role(s) within the PCN Scheme, including those relating to confidentiality and those relating to independence from commercial and other interests, and from any prior and/or present link with the persons to be examined or organisations assessed that would compromise impartiality. The information on this record shall be used as input to identify threats to impartiality. The AEC/AQB shall retain the signed forms as staff records.	
3.3	AEC staff who gain approval as Examiners and/or invigilators are required to sign a PCN24/PSL56A form for each examination in which they have an active role. By signing the PCN24/PSL56A Invigilators and Examiners are confirming compliance with the Impartiality and confidentiality requirements laid down in PCN24/CP09 especially confirming that no conflict of interest exists between themselves and the candidate and that they have not actively participated in training of the candidate within the preceding 2 years in respect of the examination attempted. The AQB Organisations should retain a copy of the PCN24/PSL56A form within the applicable exam records and they should be made available during BINDT assessments	

4 Security

4.2	Examination materials, including exam papers and practical specimens, and information on candidates, require handling with a high degree of security, confidentiality, integrity and impartiality. If data at AQB's are computerised, a documented procedure shall cover, as a minimum, general security, authorisation for access, and measures to prevent loss of hard copy and/or computerised data	
4.3	Only authorised personnel from the AQB and BINDT representatives authorised in writing by BINDT shall have access to examination material and records (see PCN24/CP19 - Informal access by third parties). Access by AEC personnel shall be restricted to approved examiners/invigilators who appear on the AQB scope of Approval. The AQB may approve specific AEC administration staff who are involved in the non-technical aspects of the examination process. Such personnel shall sign and agree to confidentiality and security arrangements.	
4.4	Secure lockable storage facilities shall be available at the AEC to ensure the security of all examination materials including examination papers and specimens whilst they are held at the	

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	AEC. The secure storage facilities shall be located in an area to which candidates do not have unsupervised access.	
4.5	Where examination material is stored at a location not under the constant supervision of AQB/AEC staff, e.g., at a site remote from any permanently established and staffed examination centre, the AQB shall notify BINDT Certification Services Division management of the location concerned, and the measures in place to safeguard the security and confidentiality of examination material. The AQB shall retain audit records of such locations which include ensuring that security of exam materials is adequately addressed. These audit records (including photographs, if required) shall be retained and made available at BINDT assessments. BINDT reserves the right to audit such storage facilities and to direct that specific additional measures be implemented to safeguard security and confidentiality	
4.6	Where examination materials are transported between the AQB and the Remote location, the AQB shall have a documented process that details the actual materials transported and includes evidence of transport to/from each location. The AQB shall ensure the security of examination materials at all times while in transit or while retained at the remote location.	
4.7	Failure to comply with these requirements for remote examinations, especially with regard to audits and security, may result in the removal of AQB approval. BINDT takes very seriously any matters that may have potential to compromise the integrity and security of the PCN scheme.	

5 Examination specimens

5.1	Are examination specimens retained at the AEC? If yes are they securely stored with access restricted to persons authorised by the AQB (appointed invigilators)?	
5.2	Is there a controlled list of PCN examination specimens held at this AEC? Is the list maintained and up to date? Is the controlled list available to BINDT upon request?	
5.3	The controlling AQB shall be responsible for ensuring that the number of specimens held by an AEC, or available on the day of any PCN examination event, is sufficient to ensure that no candidate, in that examination event is presented with any of the same examination specimens used by any other candidates during that same examination event.	
5.4	The AQB in conjunction with the AEC shall ensure that a sufficient number of specimens are available to verify that no candidates are presented with any of the same specimens at the next re-examination or re-certification event.	
5.5	Where examination specimens are the property of the AQB and stored at an AEC location, the AQB <u>SHALL</u> have a rotation plan in place, the rotation plan shall be documented within the AQB's Quality Management	

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	System QMS and made available to BINDT for review where requested.	
5.6	Where the specimens are the property of the AEC, the AEC shall relinquish <u>control</u> of the specimens to the AQB who shall assume all responsibilities associated with the specimens.	
5.7	Where the AEC is the <u>owner</u> of the examination specimens the AQB shall ensure that sufficient specimens are held at the AEC to satisfy clause 5.3 above.	
5.8	Where the AEC expects the number of candidates in any given examination event to exceed a number that renders the number of specimens held to be insufficient to meet clause 5.3, they shall notify the AQB who shall ensure that the minimum number of specimens available is sufficient to cater for the expected increased number of candidates.	
5.9	Are sufficient examination specimens made available at the AEC, at the time of examination, for test methods in which exams are conducted. <i>Note to assessor: AECs are not necessarily required to hold minimum specimen quantities and types on a full-time basis (as per PCN24/CP09 and PCN requirements) but should have access to sufficient and appropriate specimens via the AQB.</i>	
5.10	The AQB and AEC shall maintain traceable records to allow BINDT to establish verification and compliance with the requirements, during scheduled BINDT audits.	
5.11	Do the examination specimens meet PCN/CP09 requirements <i>The assessor shall record sample specimens and master reports selected for verification of compliance with CP09 requirements. The AQB shall make specimen master records available to BINDT assessors, upon request</i> <i>Master reports should not be available to AEC employees (unless authorised examiners are located there) – exam specimen master plots must remain under the control of the AQB, and any authorisation rights must be documented</i>	
5.12	Are all examination specimens evaluated independently by two personnel holding relevant certification?	
5.13	From these separate evaluations, has a master report been generated and signed by the AQB Chief Examiner initially and at each periodic review.	
5.14	Do master reports record the optimum NDT method and technique to be applied to the specimen by examination candidates?	
6. Test Equipment		
6.1	Does the AEC hold sufficient relevant test and/or inspection equipment to enable the conduct of PCN examinations for a stated number of candidates at any practical examination?	
6.2	Does the AEC have a documented calibration/verification procedure (or series of procedures) for all inspection, test and measuring equipment used in PCN examinations.	

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	<i>Note: Such procedures shall include details of equipment type, identification, location, frequency of checks, method of check, allocation of responsibility and actions to be taken when results are unsatisfactory.</i>	
6.3	The AEC shall maintain a fully documented system for the maintenance and calibration (and/or verification) of NDT Equipment. Internal verification of equipment against reference standards, or internal process checking using documented procedures/work instructions, is acceptable in determining the performance and suitability for examination equipment providing the equipment is not used for inspecting actual product against known or governing specifications. Internal verifications and process checks shall be conducted at planned intervals by AQB staff. Internal verifications and process checks shall be recorded and the records retained for audit purposes. <i>Note: With regard to equipment used solely for examination purposes, the AQB is expected to meet the requirements above. However, the calibrations conducted do not necessarily need to be traceable to National Standards except where personal safety is affected, i.e., in the case of equipment generating, emitting or monitoring ionizing radiations</i>	
6.4	Does the AQB's system require it to record any changes in equipment holdings at this AEC to BINDT?	
6.5	The AEC shall ensure an adequate supply of all consumable materials necessary for PCN examination requirements. A documented procedure is required to ensure that consumables are properly disposed of strictly in accordance with applicable regulations	
6.6	Maintenance of capability for processes involving consumable materials shall be covered by a process control procedure. Processes involving consumables shall be checked using known reference or defective standards. The tests shall be conducted at appropriate intervals that ensure the combination of equipment and consumables are capable of detecting discontinuities associated with the examinations to be conducted. BINDT considers appropriate periods to be monthly or pre-examination, as a minimum. System process checks shall be conducted by AEC staff and shall be recorded	
7. Conduct of PCN Examinations		
7.1	Does the AEC have in place an operating procedure which ensures that candidates are, at all times during examination, closely supervised by a suitably qualified and authorised examiner or invigilator who will ensure that no candidate is permitted an unfair advantage or to collude with other candidates.	
7.2	Has the AQB trained, appointed and authorised local AEC staff to act as invigilator(s) for PCN examinations. If "Yes" do these invigilators appear on the AQB scope of approval? <i>Note to auditor: Check training, appointment and authorisation records</i>	

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7.3	If "No" to 7.2 above – how does the AQB ensure that examinations conducted at the AEC are correctly invigilated by trained and authorised invigilators that appear on the AQB scope.	
7.4	Are candidates required to sign a non-disclosure or other agreement (e.g. PCN24/PSL56A) indicating their commitment not to release confidential examination materials or participate in fraudulent test-taking practices?	
7.5	Are candidates required to sign an agreement (e.g. PCN24/PSL56B) acknowledging their understanding of examination rules and conditions?	
7.6	Do staff involved with examinations ensure that no examination material is removed by any candidate?	
7.7	Does the AEC ensure that all candidates are adequately prepared on the day of the examination?	
7.8	How are candidates prevented from using red ink or correction fluid when completing PCN examination papers?	
7.9	Does the AEC ensure that mobile phones and other electronic communications devices are not present in examination facilities when PCN examinations are being conducted?	
7.10	Does the AEC allow candidates the use of an AQB provided PC or lap-top computer in the NDT instruction and NDT procedure writing section of the PCN examination? Is this covered by an operational procedure, and are records made of the candidate's use of such equipment?	

8. Consistency of PCN Examinations

4.2.5.1	Are PCN examinations marked and graded at this AEC?	
4.2.5.2	If "Yes" to 8.1 above, are the examiner(s) trained, appointed and authorised by the controlling AQB Do they appear as examiners on the AQB scope of approval?	
	If "Yes" to 8.1 above, has the AQB effectively implemented CP09 compliant moderation processes to any such examiners?	
	What arrangements are in place for the outward and return transfer of exam materials to and from the AEC? Are any such arrangements secure?	
	How does the AQB ensure that, at this AEC, a candidate is not given the same examination paper or practical specimen in any subsequent examination, including re-examination and recertification examination(s)?	
	For examinations conducted at this AEC, how does the AQB ensure that examination results notices (PCN24/PSL06) are sent to the BINDT Certification Records Office, the candidate and the individual paying the examination fee not later than 21 days from the date of the examination?	

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9. Internal Audits/AQB oversight & control		
9.1	Does the AQB implement a system of continuous monitoring and periodic internal audits of all aspects of the PCN examination processes & procedures at this AEC?	